

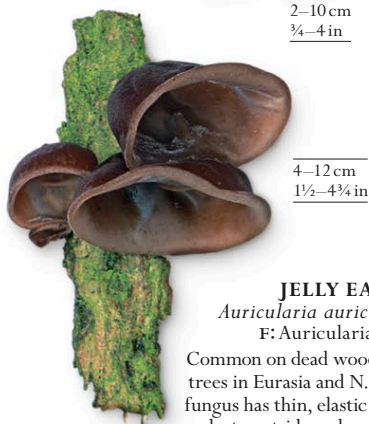
AURICULARIALES

Although often grouped with other jelly fungi, the Auriculariales are separated by their unusual basidia (spore-producing cells). These vary in shape but all are partitioned by dividing membranes into four divisions, with each division producing a spore.



TRIPE FUNGUS
Auricularia mesenterica
F: Auriculariaceae

Found in Eurasia, this species is common on dead wood, especially elm. It resembles a small bracket fungus from the top, and has a wrinkled, rubbery, greyish purple underside.



JELLY EAR
Auricularia auricula-judae
F: Auriculariaceae

Common on dead wood of deciduous trees in Eurasia and N. America, this fungus has thin, elastic "ears" that are velvety outside and wrinkled inside.



WITCHES' BUTTER
Exidia nigricans
F: Auriculariaceae

Found in temperate Eurasia and N. America, frequently on hardwood trees, it resembles a wrinkled mass of gelatinous tar. It shrivels when dry to a hard, black mass.



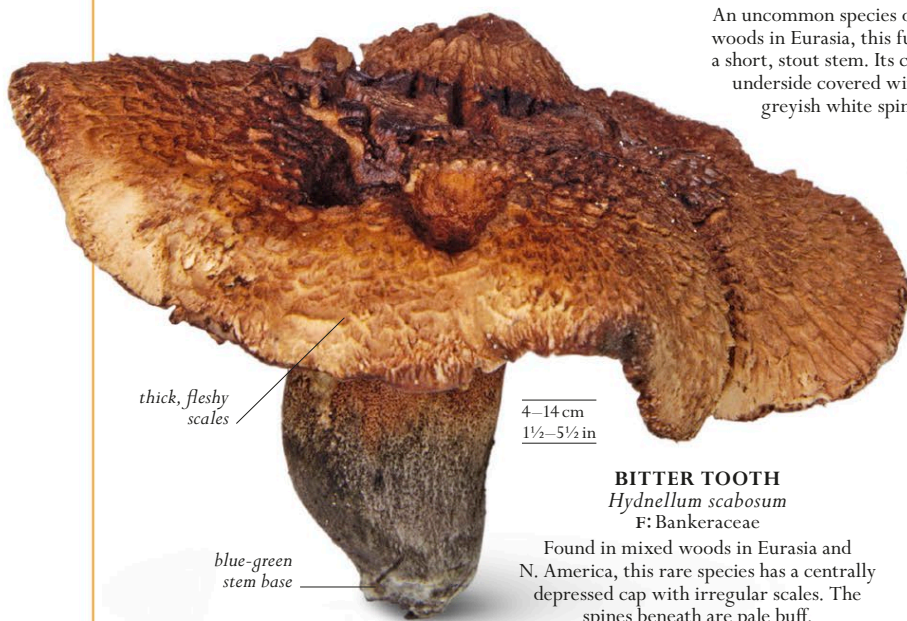
JELLY TOOTH
Pseudohydnum gelatinosum
F: Incertae sedis

This species from Eurasia and N. America has a pale translucent grey to pale brown coloration. It is occasionally found on conifer stumps.

soft, peg-like spines on underside, on which spores are formed

THELEPHORALES

This diverse group includes bracket fungi, crust fungi, earthfans, and toothed fungi. Many of these have tough, leathery flesh, and commonly feature knobbed or spiny spores. The group was only identified as a result of molecular studies as the Thelephorales have few physical features in common.



BITTER TOOTH
Hydnellum scabosum
F: Bankeraceae

Found in mixed woods in Eurasia and N. America, this rare species has a centrally depressed cap with irregular scales. The spines beneath are pale buff.



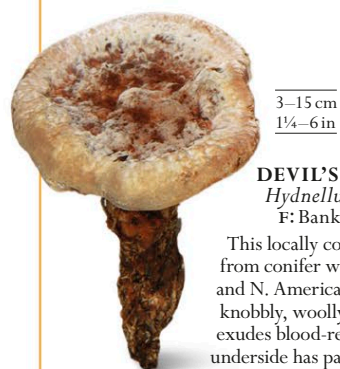
DRAB TOOTH
Bankera fuliginosa
F: Bankeraceae

An uncommon species of conifer woods in Eurasia, this fungus has a short, stout stem. Its cap has an underside covered with tiny greyish white spines.



BLACK TOOTH
Phellodon niger
F: Bankeraceae

Growing in mixed woods in Eurasia and N. America, this uncommon species smells of fenugreek when dry. The irregularly shaped cap is grey to purplish black with grey spines underneath.



DEVIL'S TOOTH
Hydnellum peckii
F: Bankeraceae

This locally common species from conifer woods in Eurasia and N. America has a flattened, knobble, woolly cap that often exudes blood-red droplets. The underside has pale brown spines.

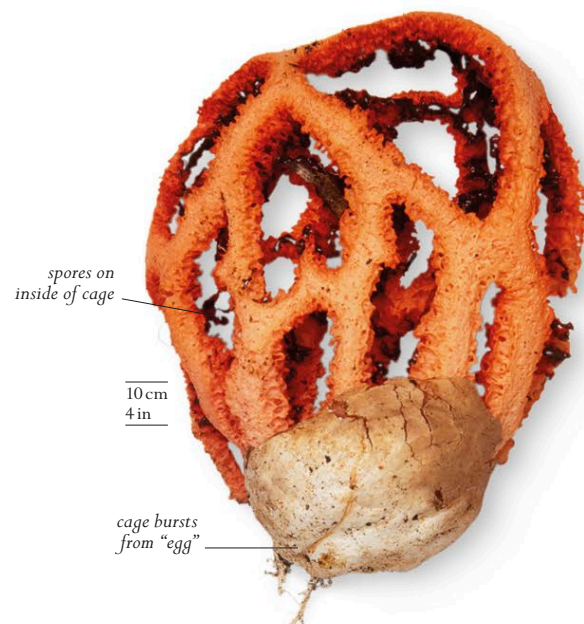


EARTHFAN
Thelephora terrestris
F: Thelephoraceae

Quite common in woods or on heaths in Eurasia and N. America, this fungus grows on soil or woody debris. Its fan-shaped fruitbodies overlap, forming clumps with paler, fringed margins.

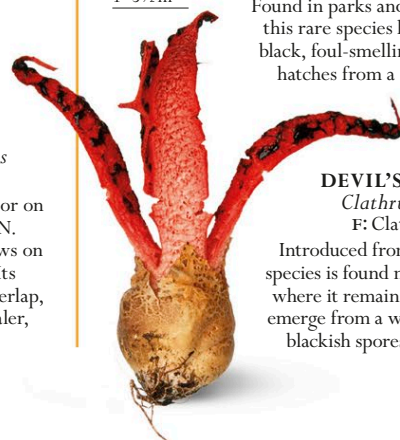
PHALLALES

Named for the phallic shape of many of the species in this group, such as the stinkhorns, this order also contains some false truffles. The stinkhorns "hatch" from an egg-like structure, often in just a few hours.



RED CAGE FUNGUS
Clathrus ruber
F: Clathraceae

Found in parks and gardens in Eurasia, this rare species has a red cage with black, foul-smelling spores. The cage hatches from a small, pale "egg".



DEVIL'S FINGERS
Clathrus archeri
F: Clathraceae

Introduced from Australasia, this species is found mainly in S. Eurasia, where it remains rare. Its red arms emerge from a white "egg" and have blackish spores that smell fetid.